

Should this feature even use AI?



6 questions I ask before adding
AI to any feature.



1.

Read More →



○ PROBLEM
○ NEED
● OUTCOME

What **user problem** are we solving?

- If the pain point is unclear, AI will only add noise.
- Start with the real job the user is trying to get done.
- If you can't explain the problem simply, the feature is probably too early.



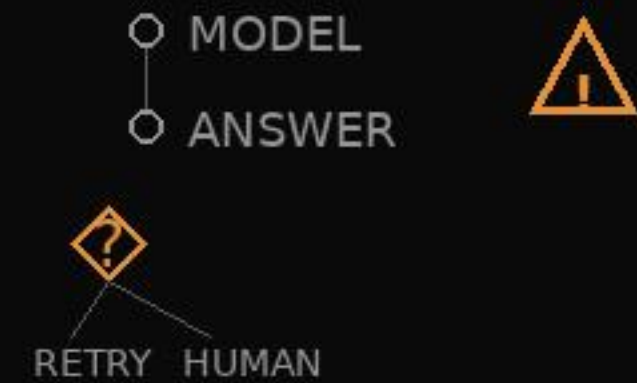
2.

Is AI the **simplest solution?**

- AI should not be the default answer.
- If rules, search, or a basic workflow solve the problem better, start there.
- Use AI only when it actually adds value the user can feel.



3.



What happens when AI gets it wrong?

- Even good models fail sometimes — design for it, don't ignore it.
- Build graceful fallbacks: retry, defer, or route to a human.
- A silent failure damages trust faster than a visible one.



4.



What is the **cost of an error?**

- A wrong answer is not equal across every product.
- In low-risk flows, mistakes may be acceptable.
- In high-stakes flows, one error can damage trust fast.



5.

○ AI
○ HUMAN

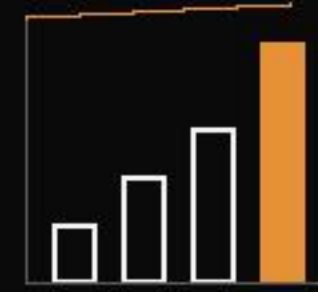
✓ APPROVED

Where does a **human stay** **in the loop?**

- High-stakes decisions need a human checkpoint before they ship.
- Review isn't a failure of the AI — it's part of the design.
- Approval builds the trust automation alone can't earn.



6.



Will this create **real ROI**?

- AI should improve something measurable — speed, quality, conversion, or customer experience.
- If the feature doesn't create real value, it probably doesn't need AI.



AI should create **value** — not just complexity.

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